

Plateau-breaking guide with advanced techniques, refeed strategies, and mindset reset — Action Checklist

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IDENTIFY YOUR PLATEAU TYPE

- ☐ **Identify Your Plateau Type:** Answer the four diagnostic questions about your deficit duration and physical symptoms to determine whether you're facing a metabolic adaptation, hormonal, neural adaptation, or water retention plateau before applying any fix.
- ☐ **Identify Your Plateau Type:** Track non-scale metrics like energy levels, body temperature, resting heart rate, and mood changes for at least two weeks because the scale alone won't tell you whether your body is still progressing or truly plateaued.
- ☐ **Identify Your Plateau Type:** Recalculate your current metabolic rate using the TDEE formula since your maintenance calories have likely dropped by 15-25% after prolonged deficit, and continuing with your original deficit is now keeping you stuck.
- ☐ **Identify Your Plateau Type:** Pinpoint water retention triggers by logging sodium intake, carbohydrate consumption, and menstrual cycle timing because water fluctuations of 1-3kg can mask actual fat loss and create a false plateau appearance.

IMPLEMENT STRATEGIC REFEEDS

- ☐ **Implement Strategic Refeeds:** Schedule a weekly planned refeed day with a 30-50% calorie increase focused on carbohydrates specifically rather than fat because carbs spike insulin to signal your body that energy is abundant and reverse hormone suppression.
- ☐ **Implement Strategic Refeeds:** Use the carb cycling method by eating 150-200% of your normal carb intake on refeed days while keeping protein and fat at maintenance levels to maximize the insulin and leptin hormone reset effect.
- ☐ **Implement Strategic Refeeds:** Plan your refeed day to follow your hardest training session because working muscles act as a carbohydrate sponge that pulls glucose from your bloodstream and amplifies the hormone signaling benefit.

- ❑ **Implement Strategic Refeeds:** Track your weight trend over a full two-week refeed cycle rather than judging refeed effectiveness by single-day scale movements since water retention and glycogen refilling create normal short-term fluctuations.

SUPPORT LONG-TERM HORMONE RESET

- ❑ **Support Long-Term Hormone Reset:** Optimize sleep quality by targeting 7-9 hours per night because poor sleep elevates cortisol, suppresses leptin, and directly counteracts the hormone reset you're trying to achieve through refeeds.
- ❑ **Support Long-Term Hormone Reset:** Manage stress through daily practices like breath work or light walks because elevated cortisol interferes with thyroid hormone conversion and prevents your metabolism from recovering during a plateau.
- ❑ **Support Long-Term Hormone Reset:** Add thyroid-supportive nutrients like selenium and zinc through foods like Brazil nuts, oysters, and pumpkin seeds because prolonged restriction often depletes these minerals needed for T3 hormone production.
- ❑ **Support Long-Term Hormone Reset:** Schedule a planned maintenance phase of 1-2 weeks at true maintenance calories every 12-16 weeks of deficit to allow your hormones, metabolism, and sanity to fully reset before continuing fat loss.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.